

Communication

Introduction:

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Create impactful and memorable introductions.
- Effectively highlight your strengths.
- Build immediate rapport with your audience.

Clear & Coherent Communication:

- Don't make assumptions when communicating
- Seek confirmation if there are some open endings(Follow Up)
- Seek clarification when in doubt (Ask Qs)
- Put forth our opinions confidently, and politely
- Communicate by mentioning the purpose upfront

Some exemplar behaviors of Corporate communication:

- Important to ask questions openly and confidently .
- Disagree in an agreeable manner
- Communicates in a strategic manner .
- Promotes continuous learning and independent behavior

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Grasp Basics: Understand key principles of clear communication.
- Overcome Barriers: Identify and address communication obstacles.
- Ensure Clarity: Make messages easy to understand.
- Maintain Coherence: Organize information logically.
- Practice Active Listening: Listen attentively and empathetically.
- Be Concise: Express ideas briefly and clearly.
- Adapt to Audience: Tailor communication to different audiences.
- Self-Reflect: Identify and improve communication habits.

Introduction to Business Communication

The key takeaways:

When communicating in a business scenario, it is of the utmost importance to understand the

purpose of your communication, the audience needs with whom you are communicating, and the tone you need to use to communicate the thought.

PAT: Purpose Audience Tone

Why is PAT important to you?

3



- When sending emails, ensure:**
- a. your tone of the email is apt
 - b. you use the right words to convey your message
 - c. you never respond when you are in anger
 - d. you clearly define the purpose of your email
 - e. you adjust your tone to suit the recipient's position
 - f. you always use polite and professional language, and avoid informal expressions



- When you are in calls, ensure:**
- a. you always start by mentioning the purpose of the conversation
 - b. you adapt your presentation to the audience needs and moods
 - c. you always speak in a professional tone using formal expressions
 - d. you avoid unnecessary jargon or informal phrases that are inappropriate



- When you are chatting on professional communication channels (e.g. Teams), ensure:**
- a. you start messaging by mentioning the purpose
 - b. you don't overload information in the texts
 - c. you use emoticons and GIFs appropriately and judiciously
 - d. you always remember professional chatting space is formal

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Why is PAT important to you?

Now that we have understood what PAT is with respect to business communication, let us look at each of the four purposes given below:.

- Informative
- Persuasive
- Instructive
- Entertaining

Example: Informative			
Why do we use it?	What kind of audience?	What kind of tone is used?	What are some contexts?
To give updates, to furnish details, to provide facts	Supervisors, other stakeholders, and peers	Neutral, objective, professional, formal, clear and concise	During project updates, daily standup calls, reports

details to provide facts.

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https://studyatkm.accenture.com/mod/h5pactivity/view.php?id=8419 Summarize

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Deep diving into PAT: Debrief

Persuasive			
Why do we use it?	What kind of audience?	What kind of tone is used?	What are some contexts?
To influence opinions, to encourage action, to persuade people	Potential customers, decision makers, stakeholders and investors	Convincing, compelling, positive, enthusiastic, credible, and persuasive	During group discussions, during brainstorming sessions

Instructive			
Why do we use it?	What kind of audience?	What kind of tone is used?	What are some contexts?
To provide guidance, to give directions, to explain a task execution	Peers, users, new joiners	Clear, supportive, encouraging, reassuring, patient, coherent, jargon free	Code creation, various processes

Entertaining			
Why do we use it?	What kind of audience?	What kind of tone is used?	What are some contexts?
To captivate, interest, to foster interest, and develop passion	General audience, event attendees	Engaging, lively, entertaining, creative, imaginative	Team gatherings

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At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Grasp Basics: Learn key concepts of business communication.
- Identify Types: Understand verbal, written, and non-verbal communication.
- Develop Professional Tone: Use an appropriate business tone.
- Ensure Clarity: Make messages clear and concise.
- Tailor to Audience: Adapt communication based on the audience.
- Build Relationships: Foster strong business connections through communication.

Writing Professional & Effective Emails

- Write Compelling Subject Lines

Writing compelling subject lines

Some final inputs on writing compelling subject lines:

Dos	Don'ts
Be clear and concise	Avoid writing ambiguous subject lines
Use actional language	Avoid typing the entire subject line in all upper-case
Keep the subject line relevant to the email's content	Refrain from overuse of punctuation
Always include key information	Avoid writing a complete sentence as a subject line
Maintain a professional tone	Avoid using jargon or unexplained acronyms

- Structure Of the Email MSg

The structure of the email message

Read the following email and let us analyse its structure:

Dear Team

I am writing to inform you of the upcoming Project Kick-off Meeting scheduled for tomorrow at 10.00 a.m. The meeting will take place in Room 108, 8th Floor, Wing A.

Agenda:

- Introduction and team overview
- Project scope and objectives
- Roles and responsibilities
- Timelines and milestones
- Q&A session

Your presence and insights are valuable to the success of this project, so please make every effort to attend.

Thank you for your attention, and I request you all to go through the attached documents before joining the call.

Regards

Naseema Richards

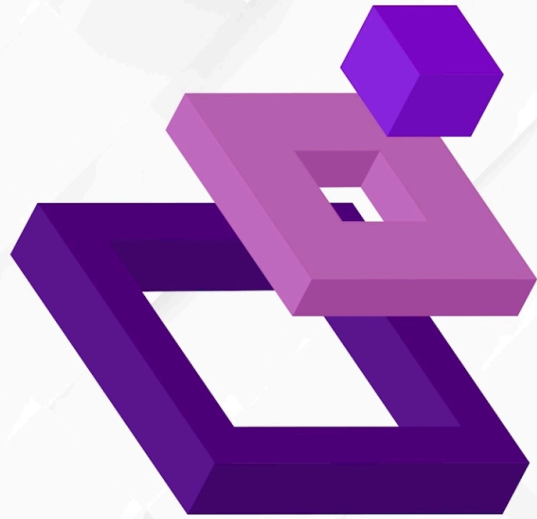
Now, let's analyze the structure

The why of the mail

The Body / The message

Call-to-action

Writing Professional & Effective Emails



- 1. **Structure of an email message consists of:**
 - a) The purpose of the email message
 - b) The body of the email message (content)
 - c) Call to Action
- 2. **The importance of a subject line in an email:**

The subject line concisely shares the purpose of the email.
- 3. **Some of the don't's of a proper subject line:**

A subject line should not –

 - (1) be ambiguous,
 - (2) be fully constructed in upper case,
 - (3) have too many punctuations,
 - (4) have a full sentence,
 - (5) have jargons or unexplained phrases.

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- **Master Structure:** Learn the standard email format.
- **Create Clear Subject Lines:** Make subject lines concise and informative.
- **Use Professional Tone:** Maintain appropriate language and tone.
- **Be Concise:** Keep your message clear and to the point.
- **Organize Content:** Structure your email logically.
- **Use Proper Greetings/Closings:** Apply correct salutations and sign-offs.
- **Proofread:** Ensure emails are error-free.
- **Attach Relevant Files:** Include necessary attachments and mention them.
- **Follow Up:** Know when and how to follow up.
- **Practice Etiquette:** Follow best practices, including CC/BCC use.

Professional Chat Etiquette

Chat etiquette comprises a set of guidelines aimed at maintaining a professional demeanor and effectively resolving issues during conversations with colleagues and business partners.

Guidelines for professional chatting

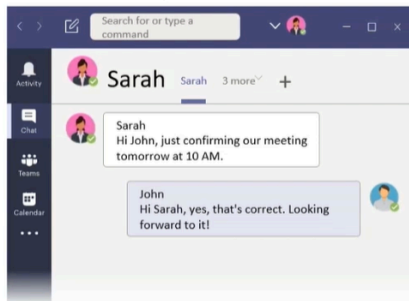


- Respect time zones and working hours (check status)
- Keep it professional
- Be clear and concise
- Use proper grammar and punctuation
- Use an appropriate tone
- Practice active listening
- Clarify misunderstandings, if any
- Avoid typing using all upper-case letters
- Respect privacy
- Acknowledge the receipt of the message and respond
- Avoid sending excessive notifications
- Use reactions, emoticons, GIFs appropriately

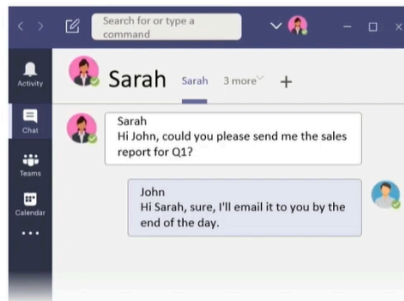
Some examples

Appropriate Chat Conduct

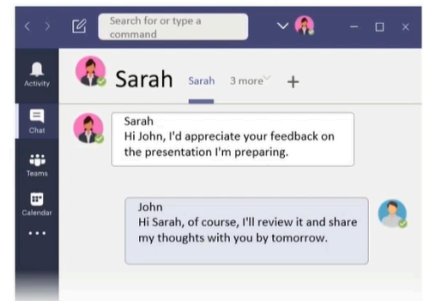
Meeting Confirmation



Request for Information



Feedback Request



These examples demonstrate clear and direct communication, focusing on specific topics and tasks relevant to the business context.

Guidelines for professional group chatting

Group IM conversations require a slightly different approach to ensure efficiency and clarity.

- Use @ mentions judiciously
- Welcome new members cordially
- Always keep your messages concise
- Acknowledge the receipt of the message and respond
- Be mindful of your tone
- Avoid unwarranted repetition
- Name the group chat for easy access of information
- Resolve conflicts, if any, in private



Professional Chat Etiquette

Essential guidelines to keep in mind while using chat apps for work:

Respecting Time Zones
and Working Hours
(Check Status),

Keep it Professional

Be Clear & Concise

Use Proper Grammar
and Punctuation

Use Appropriate Tone

Practice Active Listening

Clarify
Misunderstandings

Avoid Typing in
Upper Case

Respect Privacy

Acknowledge Receipt
of the Message
and Respond

Avoid Sending
Excessive Notifications

Use Reactions, GIFs,
Emoticons Appropriately

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Learn Chat Basics: Grasp essential chat communication principles.
- Maintain Professional Tone: Use appropriate language.
- Be Clear and Concise: Deliver direct, efficient messages.
- Use Proper Greetings: Start chats politely.
- Respond Promptly: Reply in a timely manner.
- Respect Boundaries: Be mindful of timing and context.
- Use Emojis Wisely: Apply them appropriately.
- Handle Sensitive Topics Tactfully: Approach with care.
- Practice Active Listening: Respond attentively.

- Close Properly: End with clear conclusions.

Interpersonal Communications

Interpersonal communication is exchanging information, meaning, feelings, and opinions between two or more people via verbal and non- verbal means.

Why listening is important?



- Understanding Complex Problems
- Collaboration
- Client and Stakeholder Relations
- Innovation
- Conflict Resolution

Strategies to Listen Actively



Some more thoughts...

Q. Why is listening important?

Ans. Listening is crucial in interpersonal communication because it:

1. Builds Trust: Shows you value the speaker, fostering trust and respect.
2. Enhances Understanding: Improves comprehension of the speaker's perspective.
3. Reduces Misunderstandings: Clarifies information, preventing errors.
4. Promotes Empathy: Helps you understand and share others' feelings.
5. Encourages Openness: Makes others feel heard, leading to honest communication.
6. Improves Conflict Resolution: Ensures all parties feel understood, aiding in conflict resolution.
7. Facilitates Collaboration: Enhances team cohesion and productivity.
8. Supports Effective Leadership: Helps leaders understand and support their team better.

Q. Interpersonal Communication: What is the impact of not listening?

1. Misunderstandings: Increased errors and confusion.
2. Conflict Escalation: Issues can worsen.
3. Damaged Relationships: Erosion of trust and respect.
4. Decreased Productivity: Inefficiencies and mistakes.
5. Lack of Empathy: Others feel ignored or undervalued.
6. Missed Opportunities: Overlooked important information.
7. Poor Team Dynamics: Reduced collaboration and cohesion.
8. Ineffective Leadership: Uninformed decisions and unmet team needs.

Q. Interpersonal Communication: How can we become better listeners?

Ans.

1. Not talking while the other person speaks
2. Preparing oneself to listen
3. Putting the speaker at ease
4. Removing distraction
5. Empathizing
6. Being patient
7. Avoiding personal prejudice or bias
8. Listening to the tone
9. Listening for ideas not just words
10. Waiting & watching for non-verbal cues



and empathizing

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Learn Basics: Understand key interpersonal communication principles.
- Develop Active Listening: Enhance listening skills.
- Use Verbal/Non-Verbal Cues: Communicate effectively with words and body language.
- Adapt to Personalities: Communicate with diverse personality types.
- Resolve Conflicts: Manage disagreements constructively.
- Foster Teamwork: Build strong collaboration.
- Strengthen Relationships: Build strong professional and personal connections

Giving & Receiving Feedback

Steps to seek Feedback



Q. Why is it important to prepare ourselves to receive Feedback?

Ans. Preparing to receive feedback is important because it:

1. Enhances Growth: Identifies areas for improvement.
2. Improves Performance: Provides actionable insights.
3. Builds Resilience: Strengthens emotional resilience.
4. Strengthens Relationships: Fosters trust and respect.
5. Promotes Open Communication: Encourages transparency.
6. Reduces Defensiveness: Helps receive feedback constructively.
7. Increases Self-Awareness: Clarifies others' perceptions of you.

Q. Giving & Receiving Feedback: How can we seek feedback effectively?

Ans. To seek feedback effectively:

1. **Identify Purpose:** Know why you need feedback.
2. **Choose Wisely:** Select the right people.
3. **Ask Specifically:** Formulate clear questions.
4. **Be Receptive:** Stay open-minded.
5. **Listen Actively:** Pay attention fully.
6. **Clarify:** Ask for more details if needed.
7. **Express Gratitude:** Thank the person.
8. **Take Action:** Implement the feedback.
9. **Follow Up:** Show progress and seek further input.

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Learn Feedback Basics: Understand the importance of feedback.
- Receive Feedback Openly: Be receptive and non-defensive.
- Give Constructive Feedback: Provide helpful, supportive input.
- Apply Feedback: Use input to improve skills.
- Listen Actively: Fully understand the feedback given.
- Be Specific: Use clear examples in feedback.
- Maintain Professionalism: Keep interactions respectful.
- Focus on Growth: Highlight areas for improvement.
- Encourage Dialogue: Promote open communication.

Personal Brand

What is Personal Brand



- Personal branding is the process by which we **unearth what makes us special and then communicate** that branding message to the proper audience.
- Think of it as the **behaviors, characteristics and qualities** that people associate with your name.
- It's the **perceptions that people hold, based on how they experience** you in daily interactions.

Q. What is Personal Brand and why is it important?

Ans. Personal Brand: It is your unique combination of skills, experiences, and personality that others see.

Importance:

1. Differentiates: Highlights your unique strengths.
2. Builds Credibility: Establishes trust and reputation.
3. Attracts Opportunities: Draws employers and clients.
4. Enhances Networking: Facilitates connections.
5. Boosts Confidence: Increases self-awareness and confidence.
6. Increases Influence: Strengthens authority in your field.
7. Ensures Consistency: Maintains a clear message.

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Define and communicate your unique value.
- Strengthen your professional identity and visibility in your field.

Communicating & Collaborating as a Team

What Sets a Successful Team Apart from Others?

Features of a successful team



Communicating Effectively within Teams

Attributes of Effective Communication



Q. **Communicating & Collaborating as a team: Why is it important?**

Ans. Collaborating at work is important because it:

1. **Combines Skills:** Uses diverse skills for better outcomes.
2. **Boosts Efficiency:** Speeds up tasks by dividing work.
3. **Encourages Learning:** Provides learning opportunities.
4. **Fosters Creativity:** Promotes creative thinking.
5. **Improves Communication:** Enhances communication skills.
6. **Strengthens Relationships:** Builds trust and relationships.
7. **Increases Engagement:** Boosts morale and teamwork.

Q. **Communicating & Collaborating as a team: How can we work better as a team?**

Ans.

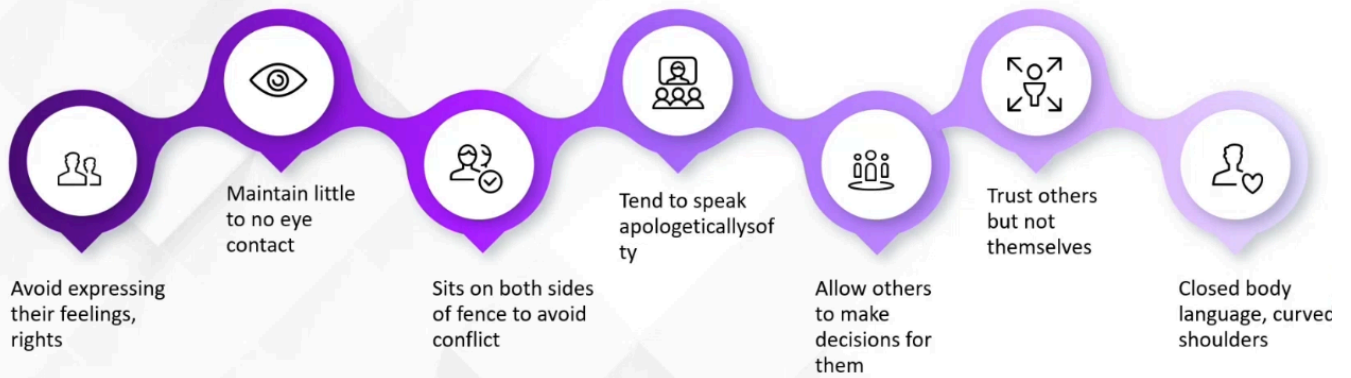
1. **Clear Goals:** Ensure everyone knows what to achieve.
2. **Open Communication:** Share ideas and updates openly.
3. **Collaboration:** Value diverse perspectives and support each other.
4. **Defined Roles:** Clarify responsibilities for accountability.
5. **Trust and Respect:** Build trust and show respect.
6. **Feedback:** Provide and receive feedback for improvement.
7. **Conflict Resolution:** Address conflicts constructively.
8. **Celebrate Success:** Recognize achievements together.

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

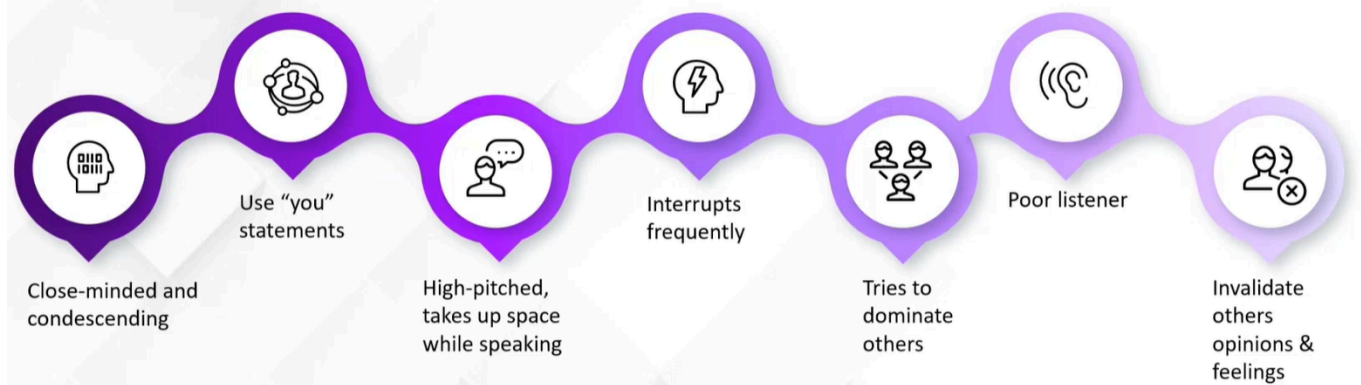
- Work cohesively and share information effectively as a team.
- Leverage diverse skills to achieve common goals.

Communication Styles

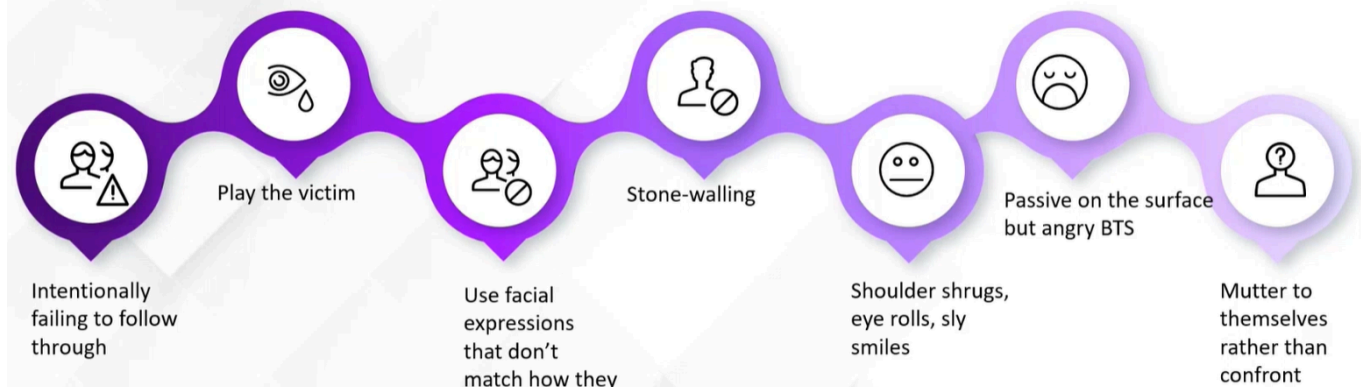
Passive Communication Style



Aggressive Communication Style



Passive Aggressive Communication Style



Assertive Communication Style

I want to express...
I hear what you are saying...
I acknowledge your...
I agree with you, I also suggest...
I request you to consider...



Use 'I' Statements



- Using I statements lets others know what you're thinking or feeling without sounding accusatory.
- Keep your requests simple, specific and clear.
- For instance, say, "I disagree," rather than, "You're wrong." If you have a request, say, "I would like you to help with this" rather than, "You need to do this."

Use Positive Body Language

Practice assertive body language in front of a mirror or with a friend or colleague.

- Eyes are relaxed and present, not looking away
- Encouraging Smile
- Open hands, not hidden from the speaker. No brushing of palms against one another signaling confusion/uncertainty.
- Straight back, not slouched, leaning backwards/forwards.
- Legs shoulder width apart, not crossed, not hidden



Let's look at Assertive responses



Let's look at Assertive responses

Context: Person B is an assertive communicator and has already chosen a project to work based on priorities of self and discussion with Team Lead. Person A is the lead on another project, Person B didn't choose to work on.

A: I can't believe you refused to work on this project.

B: Yes, I couldn't prioritize working on that project.

A: I will make sure you are compensated well if you do it.

B: I understand this is important to you. However, I have already committed to another project deadlines. I won't be able to do justice to the project.

A: Will you do it as a personal favor?

B: You know I value our partnership, but I will not be able to commit to the project this time. I look forward to working with you in the future.

Case Study: Let's meet!



Passive Peter

A team member who tends to avoid conflict and doesn't communicate openly



Aggressive Aaron

A senior executive known for his confrontational and forceful approach in communication.



Passive-Aggressive Pam

A colleague who often expresses resentment & indirect snarky remarks.



Assertive Angela

A project manager known for her direct and confident communication style

Q. Communicating Styles: Why is it important to be Assertive?

An assertive communication style is crucial in the workplace for its ability to promote clear and respectful interactions, resolve conflicts effectively, and foster collaborative problem-solving. It empowers individuals to express their thoughts and needs confidently while also considering the perspectives of others, leading to positive relationships and a conducive work environment. Assertiveness helps in setting and maintaining healthy boundaries, boosting confidence, and advocating for one's ideas and career growth, ultimately contributing to improved communication, teamwork, and overall success in the workplace.

Q. Communicating Styles: How can one become more assertive at work?

Ans.

1. Understand yourself and your communication style.
 2. Learn assertive techniques like "I" statements and direct communication.
 3. Set clear boundaries and priorities.
 4. Practice active listening and manage emotions.
 5. Start with low-risk situations and gradually apply assertiveness.
 6. Seek feedback and build confidence.
 7. Role-play and practice assertive skills regularly.
 8. Keep learning and improving assertiveness over time.
-

Q. Communicating Styles: Importance of positive body language.

Ans. Positive body language is key in the workplace for effective communication, building trust, and showing professionalism. It includes smiling, maintaining eye contact, and open gestures that foster positive relationships and a supportive environment.

Confidence and engagement are conveyed through active listening cues, contributing to better understanding and collaboration. Overall, positive body language enhances the workplace atmosphere, boosts morale, and improves productivity and teamwork.

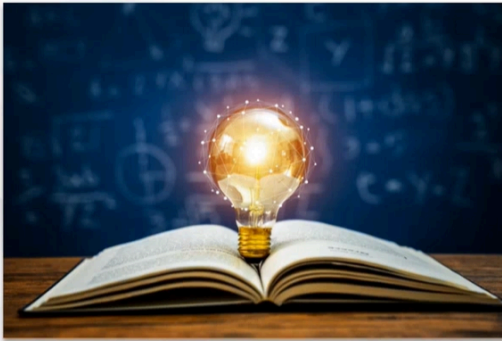
At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Recognize and adapt to various communication styles.
- Enhance your ability to connect.
- Collaborate effectively with diverse individuals.

Prioritizing Tasks

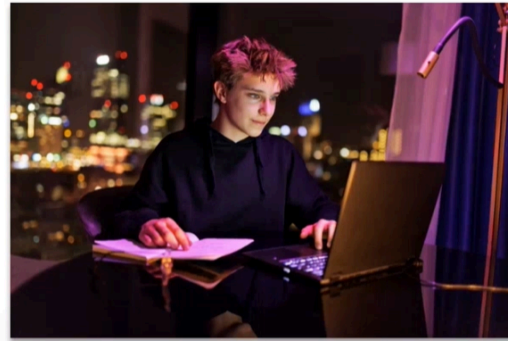
Prioritization of Tasks

Important



Tasks directly tied to goals, long-term success, or strategic objectives

Urgent



Immediate tasks due to deadlines or external pressures.

Urgent and Important (Do first):

1. Tasks requiring immediate attention.
2. Critical deadlines, emergencies.
3. High-priority tasks

Examples: Software bug fixes, server downtime during peak hours, critical project deadlines, nature's call

Important but Not Urgent (Do Later):

1. Long-term planning, skill development.
2. Strategic tasks for success.

Examples: Project planning, code quality assurance, financial planning, updating LinkedIn with recent professional development, relationship building

Eisenhower Matrix Prioritization Technique

Urgent but Not Important (Delegate):

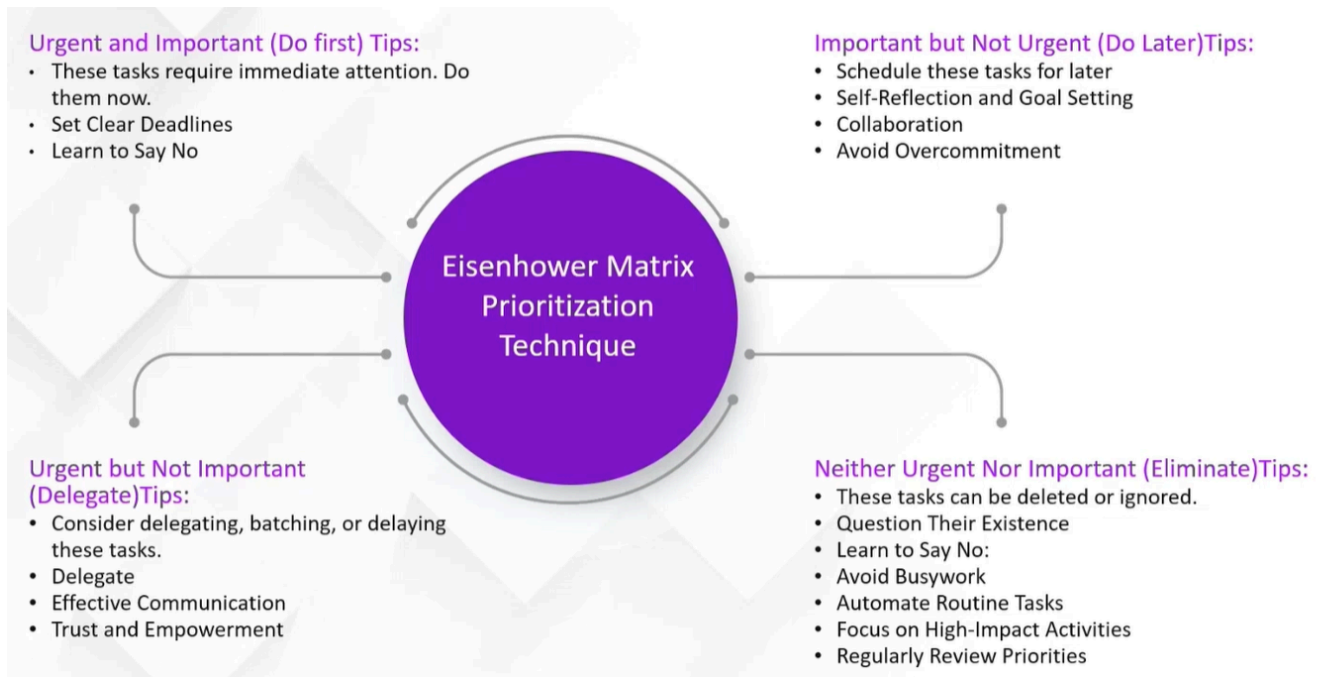
1. Interruptions, distractions.
2. Delegate when possible.

Examples: Non-essential meetings, routine emails,

Neither Urgent Nor Important (Eliminate):

1. Low-value tasks.
2. Consider eliminating.

Examples: Excessive social media browsing, trivial admin work, watching the latest episode of Euphoria, checking out Swift's newest album



Q. Prioritization of Work: Why do we need to prioritize work?

Ans.

Prioritizing tasks is essential because it:

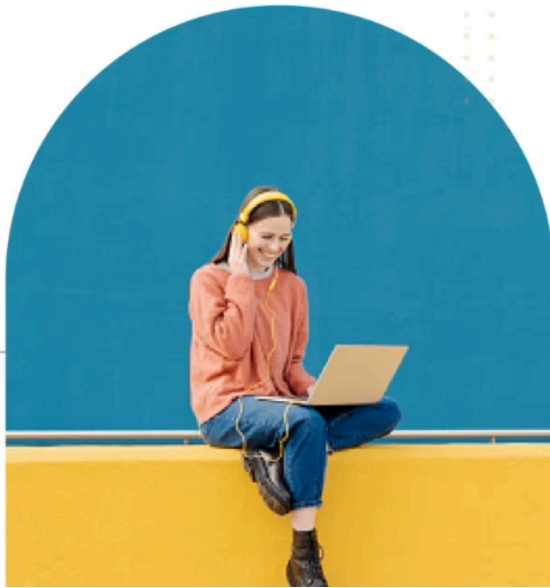
- 1. Focuses on Key Tasks:** Identifies important tasks for efficiency.
- 2. Reduces Overwhelm:** Prevents feeling swamped.
- 3. Meets Deadlines:** Ensures timely completion.
- 4. Improves Time Management:** Enhances productivity.
- 5. Minimizes Stress:** Reduces overwhelm and stress.
- 6. Achieves Goals:** Aligns tasks with objectives for success.

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Identify and focus on high-impact tasks
- Enhance productivity
- Ensure effective time management

Setting Smart Goals

Why don't more people set goals?



- Fear of Failure
- Limited Thinking
- Pessimistic Attitude
- Fear of Rejection
- Procrastination
- Low Self Esteem
- Lack of Awareness on goal setting
- Knowledge of techniques

S.M.A.R.T goals?

S - Specific

For example, "I want to lose weight."

This is wishful thinking. It becomes a goal when I pin myself down to "I will lose 10 pounds in 90 days."

M - Must be measurable If we cannot measure it, we cannot accomplish it. Measurement is a way of monitoring our progress.

For example, 10 pounds/90 days are measurement.

A - Must be achievable Achievable means that it should be out of reach enough to be challenging but it should not be out of sight, otherwise it becomes heartening.

R - Realistic A person who wants to lose 50 pounds in 30 days is being unrealistic.

T - Time-bound There should be a starting date and a finishing date.

Q. Smart Goals: Why do we need to have SMART goals?

Ans. SMART goals are useful because they:

1. Clarify Objectives: Define what you want to achieve.
2. Provide Focus: Prioritize efforts effectively.
3. Set Clear Success Criteria: Establish measurable goals.
4. Boost Motivation: Inspire action and drive.
5. Enhance Accountability: Hold you accountable.
6. Aid Planning: Assist in creating actionable plans.
7. Encourage Evaluation: Enable progress tracking and adjustments.

At the end of this topic, you should be able to:

- Create specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound goals.
- Drive clarity and accountability in your personal and professional pursuits.